

❖ **CASE STUDY**

❖ **Introduction**

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has become one of the most widely used digital payment systems in India. Mobile applications such as Google Pay, PhonePe, and Paytm enable users to transfer money instantly. However, the rapid growth of digital payments has also led to an increase in cyber fraud cases.

❖ **Case Description**

Rohit, a college student, decided to sell his old smartphone on an online marketplace. A buyer contacted him and agreed to make an advance payment. The buyer sent Rohit a QR code and instructed him to scan it in order to receive the payment. Trusting the buyer, Rohit scanned the QR code and entered his UPI PIN. Instead of receiving money, ₹10,000 was deducted from his bank account.

❖ **How the Fraud Occurred**

- The QR code was designed to request money, not send it
- The scammer misled Rohit by giving false instructions
- Rohit entered his UPI PIN without verifying the transaction
- Lack of awareness led to the fraud

❖ **Impact**

- Financial loss of ₹10,000
- Emotional stress and anxiety
- Loss of trust in online transactions.

❖ **Key Learning**

Users must understand that entering a UPI PIN always authorizes a payment, not receiving money. Awareness and caution are essential while using digital payment systems.